

Romance automated?

How bad could it be for the Internet of Things to automate romance?
<http://dgit.in/1PtKqJd>



Internet reduces attention spans

Microsoft conducted research which shows that prolonged internet usage reduces attention spans.
<http://dgit.in/1LOWZVN>

DO

Do (more... by doing) nothing

The art of doing nothing at all, effectively, is a happy place to be.
Here's how you do absolutely zilch, and then some.

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Technically, it's impossible for us humans (or any other living physical entity) to do nothing. No matter how hard you try, involuntarily your body is always doing something – breathing, thinking, digesting, sleeping (yes, it's an activity). You can't get a break even after you die because your body starts furiously decomposing itself and driving it back to nothingness. So, yeah – doing nothing at all isn't as easy as it sounds. However, let's attempt it anyway.

What do we mean by not doing anything? Trying to break the daily cycles, taking a pause from our hectic schedule, and doing something less hectic that almost borders on a laziness overdose. Here's how you truly can try to do nothing to do more.

Sleep

It's the easiest thing to do to kill time and do nothing at the same time. Don't feel like going to school or work to get your daily dose of activity? Woke up on the lazy side of the bed? Don't worry. Call in sick. Close the window blinds, shoo the sun away. Play *Koop Island Blues* (probably the most hauntingly sleepy lullaby ever). Hug that pillow tightly like your life depends on it... and dive right into bed.



Dump digital distractions

When you're serious about doing nothing, you can't be connected to your digital umbilical cord. It has to be severed. That means no phones or laptops, no tablets or smartwatches. Definitely, no Internet. Go gadget free, switch them off and hide them in a safe, and most importantly avoid the temptation to go look for them every 11 minutes or so. Going by how addicted people are getting to their digital devices and are so overly consumed by the black hole that is the Internet, not having these digital distractions will be disorienting enough to give you the good enough feeling of having done nothing all that while. Go ahead, just try it. Your sanity will thank you later.

Breathing

One of the best and easiest way to give your brain a quick timeout is to drop everything you're doing and focus on your breathing. Nope, this has nothing to do with meditation – you only have to focus on your breathing, and closing your eyes helps you focus better, that's all. Breathe in, breathe out, focus on the air entering your nose, travelling down your windpipe, filling your lungs, and vice versa. Do



this in your break time, not being distracted by anything, and it should calm your brain and give it a boost of sorts.

Numb the senses

The next level of doing nothing takes a bit of planning. The jury's still out on the benefits of sensory deprivation at a scientific level, but the activity itself has been in vogue for more than a couple of decades. The idea here is to deprive your senses of any stimulus. The best way to experience sensory deprivation would be by lying in a bathtub (or floatation tank, look it up) with the water temperature matching your exact body temperature. Cover your eyes with dark eye pads, making sure no light enters, put on earmuffs (or anything that blocks sound), and try to float in the bathtub for a while. It should take about 20 minutes or so for your nerves to stop seeking stimulus, and then... all goes

quiet. It's an odd feeling, mind you, for the time it lasts. But when you snap out of this funk, the sensory overload is a unique experience – your nerves are tingling with sensation, colours seem more vivid, you have a heightened sense of hearing, and you feel more alive than you will ever remember. **[1]**